

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

16th NOV, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

46th WEEK



GAZA & PLIGHT OF PALESTINIANS

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

16th NOVEMBER, 2018

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Gaza on the brink

Israel and Hamas need to pull back to allow humanitarian intervention in the territory

The sudden flare-up in Gaza between Palestinian militant groups and Israel is another grim reminder that the situation in the blockaded Mediterranean strip remains precarious. The latest violence was triggered by a botched spy operation by Israeli commandos inside Gaza that killed seven Palestinians, including a Hamas military commander. Hamas, which controls the territory, and Islamic Jihad fired hundreds of rockets and mortar shells into Israel in retaliation. Israel responded with airstrikes and artillery fire, hitting scores of military posts and weapons depots across Gaza. They levelled television and radio stations as well as Hamas's military intelligence headquarters. It was the heaviest Israeli attack since the 2014 war on the impoverished enclave of 1.82 million people. Now, Gaza is staring at the prospect of a fourth war in a decade. The territory has been on the brink for years. In past wars, Israel inflicted enormous havoc on the enclave's public infrastructure and caused high human casualties, while in retaliation Hamas fired rockets into Israel's civilian areas. Israel has also imposed a land, sea and air blockade on the region in a bid to stop Hamas from amassing more weapons and to weaken its hold over the strip. But Hamas continues to control Gaza, having found multiple ways to smuggle in weapons, while ordinary Gazans bear the brunt of the blockade. Joblessness is 40%. The administration has no control on exports or imports, and is not even paying full salaries to government employees. Due to scarcity of diesel, there are extended power cuts. Sewage plants are not operational. In effect, Israel has imposed collective punishment.

The situation has been particularly tense in recent months. In March, thousands of Palestinians marched towards the border, demanding their right to return to the homes and lands their families were expelled from in the first Arab-Israeli war of 1948, immediately after the creation of the state of Israel. About 750,000 Palestinians were estimated to have been forced out of their homes during the war. The March of Return protests continued on the border since then, and have often been met with live bullets fired by Israeli soldiers. Since March, at least 200 Palestinians have been killed by Israeli soldiers and thousands of others wounded. It was against this background that Egypt and Qatar stepped in, offering to mediate talks and provide much needed resources to the enclave. Israel initially responded positively, letting fuel tanks and Qatari money into Gaza. That should have set the stage for further dialogue, but Israel's undercover mission inside the enclave subverted it, triggering the current crisis. After both sides announced a ceasefire, violence on the border continued, underscoring how dangerous the situation is. They should restrain themselves, allowing peace efforts led by Egypt to continue. Gaza needs aid, not another war.

2 Gaza on the brink

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UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora.



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CURRENT AFFAIRS



ISRAEL-PALESTINE CONFLICT



27th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

3rd July to 9th July, 2017



Cyprus

SYRIA

Learning Space

Mediterranean Sea

LEBANON

Sea of Galilee

WEST BANK

ISRAEL

IRAQ

Jordan River

Dead Sea

HEBRON

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba

Learning Space



Cyprus

SYRIA



Learning Space

Mediterranean Sea

LEBANON

WEST BANK

GAZA STRIP

IRAQ

ISRAEL

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba



Learning Space



LET US LOOK AT THE HISTORY OF PRESENT DAY ISRAEL/ PALESTINE



- 1** In a nut shell, during the past 2,000 years most of the Jewish population were either killed or forced to leave.
- 2** Meanwhile, Arab speaking Muslims became the dominant ethnic group in this area.
- 3** Palestine came under Ottoman Empire for several centuries. In the year 1900, the population of Palestine was 6 lakh, out of which 94% were Arabs.
- 4** The movement called Zionism which began in late 1800s influenced many Jews from around the world to move to Palestine to reclaim their ancient homeland of Israel.
- 5** Palestine came under the British mandate since 1920. Prior to that Balfour Declaration was given by British in 1917, which facilitated settlement of Jews here.
- 6** The number of Jews has risen to a point by 1930s that alarmed many Palestinian Arab leaders. Great Arab Revolt took place against the British.



LET US LOOK AT THE HISTORY OF PRESENT DAY ISRAEL/ PALESTINE



Palestinian & Jewish Land 1946



UN Partition Plan 1947



7 The British put down the revolt with the help of Jewish militias and subsequently the hostility increased between Jews and Arabs.

8 As a consequence, Jews and Palestinians formed militias and other military units to fight each other.

9 The Arabs' opposition developed into the 1936–1939 Arab revolt in Palestine. The Jewish resistance developed into the Jewish insurgency in Palestine (1944–1947).

Ultimately it resulted in civil war in 1947.



LET US LOOK AT THE HISTORY OF PRESENT DAY ISRAEL/ PALESTINE



10

Subsequently, plan of partition by United Nations was announced on 29 November 1947, which planned to divide Palestine into three areas: an Arab state, a Jewish state and the Special International Regime for the cities of Jerusalem and Bethlehem.

11

On 15 May 1948 the ongoing civil war transformed into an inter-state conflict between Israel and the Arab states, following the Israeli Declaration of Independence the previous day.

12

Israel forces defeated the Palestinian militias and Arab armies. This turned 7 lakh Palestinian civilians into refugees.

NEWS REPORT



- 1 There is renewed violence in Gaza between Palestinian militant groups and Israel.

- 2 It is because of a botched spy operation by Israeli commandos inside Gaza, that killed seven Palestinians.

- 3 Hamas, which controls the territory, and Islamic Jihad fired hundreds of rockets and mortar shells into Israel in retaliation.

- 4 Israel responded with airstrikes and artillery fire.

This was the heaviest Israeli attack since the 2014 war on the impoverished enclave of 1.82 million people. And, it is staring at the prospect of a fourth war in a decade.

THE SUFFERERS ARE ORDINARY GAZANS



Restraint is the need of the hour and the efforts led by Egypt should continue, Gaza Strip needs aid, not another war.

- 1 Ordinary Gazans are facing the problems.
- 2 Hamas is amassing more weapons through multiple ways to smuggle the weapons.
- 3 The joblessness is 40%, administration has no control on exports or imports, it is not even paying full salaries to Government employees.
- 4 There are extended power cuts due to the scarcity of diesel, Sewage plants are not operational.

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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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